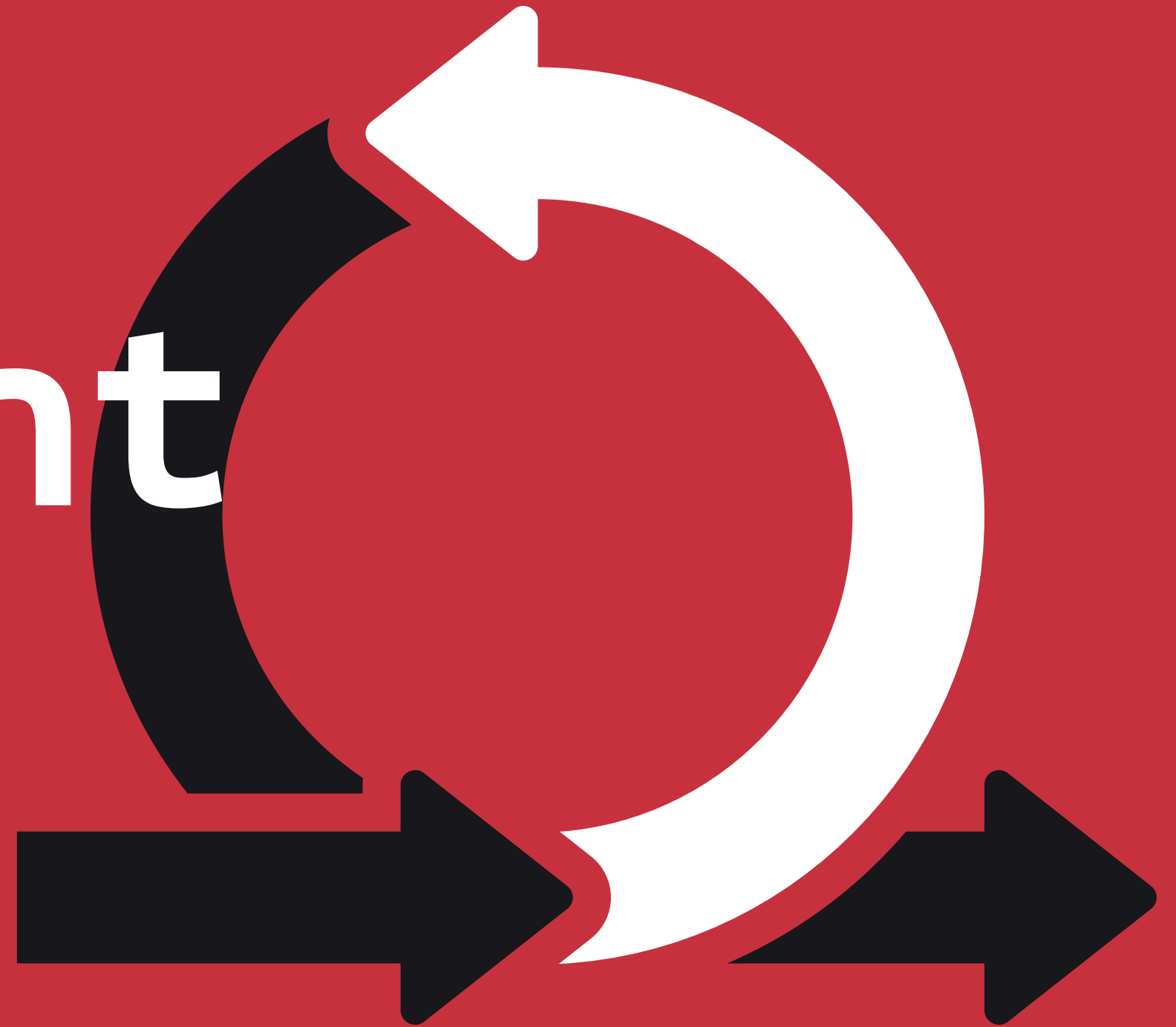


Agile Development

WEBSITES THAT EVOLVE



Website Owner's Manual

1

The Website Owner's Manual

A customisable guide for creating an effective online identity.

Supporting Resources:
[Website Cover & Structure](#)
[Website Whiteboard](#)



Your Brand Name

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2

Preface

The Website Owner's Manual is a project management tool. A hub for strategic planning, brand assets, and resources.

Its job is to give owners control over the legal, technical, and business responsibilities they inherit with website ownership.

It does this by providing an ordered checklist of standards to follow.

STANDARDS

- [Inclusive Design](#) - Designing for all.
- [Content Design](#) - Meeting needs.
- [Web Standards](#) - Building resilience.
- [Agile Development](#) - Being adaptable.
- [IndieWeb](#) - Taking control.

These are links to short explainer articles on the approach used.

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Road Map



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Foundation & Strategy

Who are we and why should anyone care?

Brand Purpose & Vision
Why the business exists. Core values and aims. Emotions it evokes.
Target Audience
Persons, demographics, visitor behaviour and challenges.
Market Position Statement
Where you sit and what you stand for. Brand promise.

SEO Strategy
Domain name. Achievable traffic. Content gaps. Keyword competition. Search intent. EAT (Experience, Expertise, Authoritativeness, and Trustworthiness).
Competitor Analysis
Competitors' strengths and weaknesses. Differentiation opportunities.
Content Design
What users actually need.

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Principles

Business

- Problem before product.
- Justification before dependencies.
- Local skills before global platforms.
- Simplicity before automation.

Design

- Content before design.
- User needs before stakeholder ego.
- Objectives before personal taste.

Web

- Fluid before fixed units.
- Mobile before desktop.
- Semantics before styling.
- Performance before bloat.
- Accessibility before complexity.

Agile Development...

An agile approach treats a website as a living product, not a one-off deliverable. It emphasises starting small, learning from real-world use, and iterating based on feedback and changing conditions. In practice, this means we:

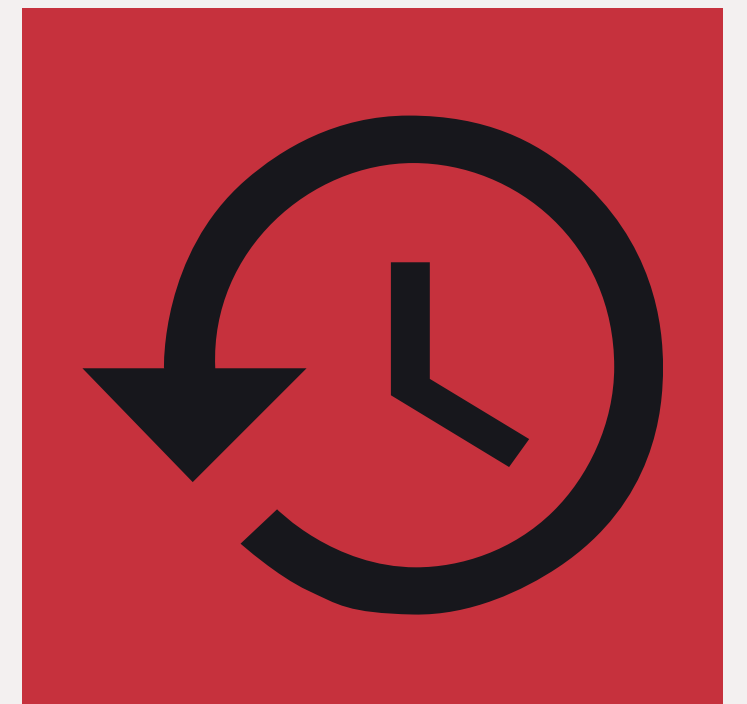
- Start with a Minimum Viable Product rather than a “perfect” first version.
- Deliver improvements in small increments instead of big launches.
- Use feedback to guide rather than sticking rigidly to initial assumptions.

It's a mindset more than a specific process. It shapes how we plan, decide, and work together over the whole life of the site.



The Historical Evolution

- Agile emerged in response to the rigid, plan-heavy software delivery models that struggled with change commonly described as “waterfall”.
- In the 1990s, methods like Scrum and Extreme Programming explored faster, iterative ways of working.
- In 2001, 17 practitioners met in Snowbird, Utah and wrote the Agile Manifesto.
- Since then, Agile has spread beyond software into digital products website projects and many unrelated industries.



Why it matters

The web, our audience, and our business context will all keep changing. An agile approach helps a brand stay responsive, reduce risk, and focus effort where it makes a difference. Working in an agile way means:

- We prioritise outcomes (what works for users and the business) over outputs (how many pages or features we ship).
- We accept that some early ideas will be wrong and treat that as learning, not failure.
- We plan with intention, but leave room to adapt when evidence or circumstances change.



Core principles

This borrows from the spirit of the Agile Manifesto and apply it to web design and development:

- **People and collaboration over process and tools:** Clear communication and shared understanding beat rigid workflows.

- **Working website over exhaustive documentation:** We favour getting a usable version live, then improving it, rather than over-planning.

- **Responding to change over following a fixed plan:** We treat the plan as a guide, not a contract, and adjust it when reality disagrees.

- **User value over internal preference:** We prioritise the features and content that make a real difference to our visitors



How website owners apply this

- Define a MVP: the smallest set of pages and features that delivers genuine value.
- Work in short cycles with a “plan → build → review → adjust” rhythm.
- Regularly review analytics, feedback, and priorities, and update the backlog accordingly.
- Limit work: finish and launch small improvements rather than starting many things at once.
- Capture ideas and “nice-to-haves” in a backlog instead of trying to do everything in the first release.
- Remove or change features that are unused, confusing, or no longer aligned with goals.



References

- Manifesto for Agile Software Development – the original statement of agile values and principles
- 2 • Principles behind the Agile Manifesto – expanded principles that sit under the core values
- Agile Alliance – resources and articles on applying agile in practice
- Scrum Guides – lightweight framework often used to structure agile work (not required, but useful context
- <https://gds.blog.gov.uk/2015/07/10/you-cant-be-half-agile/>

